

MUST ANSWER QUESTIONS WITH TRUTH AND SPEED

Every draft registrant must answer his questionnaire truthfully and without evasion. Untrue answers or concealment of information required by the government will result in prosecution.

On the other hand, draft registrants may rest assured that the personal questions they are obliged to answer in regard to their domestic and business conditions will be seen only by the proper authorities. Members of local and district boards are forbidden under severe penalty from divulging such information.

The government requires the most personal and detailed answers in the questionnaire because on the information thus given, supported where necessary by affidavits of other persons, will be based the classification of each registrant.

As a deferred classification is equivalent to a temporary exemption or discharge, it must be plain to every registrant why false answers, designed to place the registrant in one of the deferred classes, will be so strictly dealt with.

In this connection an official warning that should be carefully noted by every draft registrant, has just been issued by Clarence L. Reames, United States attorney for Oregon. This warning says:

"In connection with the filling out of the questionnaires, word has been received from the attorney-general to prosecute vigorously those who make statements therein that are false.

"In view of the fact that false statements in support of claims for exemption or deferred classification constitute a grave menace to the fair and equitable enforcement of conscription, we have been requested to give wide publicity to the fact that such material false statements, even when the facts have been distorted only slightly, will be promptly prosecuted.

"Attention should be further directed to the fact that all exemptions and discharges made prior to noon on December 15 will thereafter have no validity, and to the fact that every person who has registered and is not yet in military service is required to fill out a questionnaire.

"This must be sworn to and is intended as a complete inventory of his domestic condition and industrial and educational qualifications.

"The punishment provided for those who fail to return the questionnaire, or to appear for physical examination, or to report change of status, permits imprisonment for one year."

Even though a registrant is perfectly sure he understands all that is required in the questionnaire, for his own protection he should consult one of the members of the various legal advisory boards for advice. This legal advice is free.

Questionnaires are now being sent out by local boards at the rate of five per cent each day, except Sundays and legal holidays, until all are sent out.

WATCH THE BOYS

Mrs. Burr Writes of Critical Periods in Lives of Youth

Clackamas, Ore., Dec. 18, 1917. Editor Courier: Reading the account of the tragedy out near Park-place makes one wonder if man in his rush and longing for power had better give his time and thought to a little more common every-day affairs. Teachers harp on the same things day in and day out and it would be well for our newspapers to do the same. There are three periods in a boy's life when he should be guarded. One age is when a child reaches the age of five until he is about seven. Another age is from eleven until he is about fourteen. This is the most dangerous point in a boy's life, or I should say, the turning point, and I would not trust a boy without an older boy to look after him. It is better for a boy up to the age of fifteen if he can be kept in the home and under a mother's influence.

The brain of a child is very sensitive and as the brain develops at these ages he should be guarded then—after that kept in good company.

pany. Then the next dangerous period of a man's life comes in after years, anywhere from 45 to 80 years. I cannot discuss that part of a man's life here. It is the child up to fifteen that a woman has most control over. A good mother not only looks after her own boys but at the same time throws an influence over others. Many people do not understand these periods of a boy's life, so why not the newspapers keep these questions alive and possibly we would soon be rid of war and evil which is created by man himself.

MRS. VIOLA BURR.

HIGHWAY COMMISSIONERS SUED FOR GANONG DAMAGES

J. W. Ganong and the other owners of the "Ganong Place" at Canemah Saturday brought suit for \$7500 damages against Simon Benson, W. L. Thompson, E. J. Adams and the C. J. Cook company, as a result of the alleged mutilation of valuable trees at the order of members of the state highway commission, and other damages. The complaint, signed by J. W. Ganong, Richard C. and Celia Feld Ganong and Dr. and Mrs. Hugh Mount, charges that the members of the highway commission did unlawfully, wantonly and without color of right remove certain shade and ornamental trees and shrubs and leave the premises in a dangerous condition.

The trees involved in the suit were planted on the Hedges donation land claim in the early days, and the Ganong home was built in their shade. In Clackamas county they were considered landmarks for many years. Recently the state highway commission wanted to widen the Pacific highway at Canemah. The commission filed a suit condemning its proposed right of way, and to touch the Ganong property was the only possible way of widening the highway. The commission did not wait for the prosecution of its suit, it was alleged in an injunction suit brought by the owners, but proceeded to tear the trees and shrubs out of the way.

In the complaint filed Saturday the owners value the trees at \$1500, and ask that the highway commission and the contracting company be held personally and individually responsible for the value in addition to \$1000 asked for trespass and \$5000 for exemplary damages.

STATE ASKS CLACKAMAS TO RAISE \$100,175.70

The state taxes apportioned to the several counties and the percentage each will have to pay are given in the following:

	Pct.	Amounts.
Baker	.023678	\$ 67,629.20
Benton	.026887	36,236.70
Clackamas	.035073	100,175.70
Clatsop	.026480	75,632.30
Coos	.021790	62,236.70
Crook	.005740	16,394.60
Curry	.003836	10,956.40
Deschutes	.008147	23,269.50
Douglas	.026910	76,860.50
Gilliam	.010341	29,536.00
Grant	.008046	22,981.00
Harney	.011225	32,060.90
Hood River	.010146	28,979.10
Jackson	.030859	88,139.60
Jefferson	.005402	15,429.20
Josephine	.008979	25,645.90
Klamath	.016388	46,807.50
Lake	.011120	31,761.00
Lane	.041068	117,298.60
Lincoln	.007583	21,658.60
Linn	.031636	90,358.90
Malheur	.013282	37,939.00
Marion	.043780	125,044.60
Morrow	.011121	31,763.90
Multnomah	.361057	1,031,252.80
Polk	.018520	52,896.90
Sherman	.010663	30,455.70
Tillamook	.016199	46,267.70
Umatilla	.045588	130,208.70
Union	.020490	58,523.60
Wallowa	.013323	38,053.20
Wasco	.016856	48,144.20
Washington	.029717	84,877.80
Wheeler	.004718	13,475.60
Yamhill	.022670	64,750.20
Totals	1.000000	\$2,856,205.00

MISS MOORE SURPRISES

Quietly Becomes Bride of W. A. Matheson Who is in U. S. Army

Miss Maude Moore, daughter of Mr. and Mrs. E. L. Moore, of this city, and W. A. Matheson, Sr., of Powell River, B. C., formerly of this city, "stole a march" on their parents and other relatives on last Wednesday evening, when they met in Portland and were quietly married by Rev. J. R. Landsborough, formerly of this city.

It was the ring on her finger that later aroused the suspicion of the young woman's employers, Miller & Parker, where she is a bookkeeper, and her parents when she reached her home. The tale was told, and Mrs. Matheson promised her employers that she would not desert the firm, but intended to continue her duties while her husband had gone to fight for his country.

A PRETTY WEDDING

Miss Eva Holton of Stafford Married to J. Bruce Ray

A very quick wedding was performed December 10 at the Baptist parsonage at Stafford by Rev. E. T. Judd, when Miss Eva Holton was united in marriage by J. Bruce Ray in the presence of immediate relatives. Mrs. Ray, the youngest daughter of Mrs. O. Z. Holton of Stafford, was becomingly gowned in white marquisette and satin, carrying an arm bouquet of carnations. Mr. Ray is the eldest son of Mrs. L. E. Phillips of Polk county. The young couple expect to make their future home in the upper valley.

If you are up-to-date on the news of your home county you read The Courier.

REVIEW OF AGENT'S WORK SINCE ITS START HERE

The county agent work which has been spreading over the United States with leaps and bounds since its trial in Broome county, New York, in 1911, passed the Clackamas county boundaries on the 15th day of last September, when R. J. Werner, who was formerly assistant county agent in Multnomah county, was elected to take over the work in this county.

The first step toward the organization of the farmers of the county was taken on November 1, when representatives from the Granges, Farmers' Unions and other agricultural organizations met at the county court house and organized the County Agricultural council. The council will represent the farmers of the county for the purpose of working with and advising the county agent. At the first meeting the following officers were elected: H. G. Starkweather, president; C. E. Spence, vice-president; M. C. Glover, secretary. It was during this meeting that the possibilities of the agent were thoroughly discussed and the work for the coming year was planned.

The council named nine projects for the county agent to work on the coming year. They are: (1) Eradication of moles, (2) control of Canada thistle, (3) drainage, (4) lime, (5) boys' and girls' industrial clubs, (6) livestock improvement, (7) standardization of community products, (8) field demonstrations of fertilizers, (9) control of contagious diseases of livestock. With these subjects to handle the county agent started at work with headquarters in the Publicity office of the Oregon City Commercial club.

"I am very pleased at the attitude that most farmers are taking to the work. It is a new work and many unfounded statements have been made by lime agents and others who are either out of all they can get for themselves or have not acquainted themselves with the work, but the large majority are cooperating with me and with this spirit existing we will have results to show for our work in the near future." That is the way Mr. Werner expressed himself regarding the work.

OUTLOOK IS BRIGHT

Dun's Report Says Wheat Has Mostly Passed from Farms

The large part of the wheat crop of the Pacific northwest has passed out of farmers' hands, according to reports to the Food Administration Grain corporation. In spite of the embargo against shipments to the coast terminals in the first half of the month, Portland receipts in November were 962,000 bushels as against 629,300 bushels in November, 1916. There is no further delay in marketing the crop and settlements are made with farmers, even when the coast mills are not ready to take over the grain. The mills here are running at nearly full capacity, chiefly on flour to be shipped to the allies. The food administration will make all allotments for January flour deliveries within a few days. All of the flour milled so far for government account has been shipped to the eastern seaboard by rail. No wheat was exported from Portland in the past month, and shipments to California were light, owing to the scarcity of steamers.

The car shortage still restricts the movement of potatoes, onions, and apples to eastern and southern markets, and as the Oregon demand is not sufficient to take care of all offerings, prices are easier. The wool market is still inactive. There are continued inquiries from the east, but buyers want concessions which holders here are not yet ready to make. Notice from Washington that the brewing of beer will not be prohibited encourages hop growers to believe that better prices will prevail after the turn of the year, particularly as it is known that a large number of short contracts have not yet been covered, and not to exceed 5,000 bales are left in first hands in Oregon. The present quotation is 20 cents.

Williams Can't Understand

Bert Williams, the famous colored comedian, has written an article for the January American magazine in which he says:

"People sometimes ask me if I would not give anything to be white. I answer, in the words of the song, most emphatically 'No.' How do I know what I might be if I were a white man? I might be a sand-hog, burrowing away and losing my health for eight dollars a day. I might be a street-car conductor at twelve or fifteen dollars a week. There is many a white man less fortunate and less well equipped than I am. In truth, I have never been able to discover that there was anything disgraceful in being a colored man. But I have often found it inconvenient—in America.

"How many times have hotel keepers said to me, 'I know you, Williams, and I like you, and I would like nothing better than to have you stay here, but you see we have Southern gentlemen' in the house and they would object."

"Frankly, I can't understand what it is all about. I breathe like other people, eat like them—if you put me at a dinner table you can be reasonably sure that I won't use the ice cream fork for my salad; I think like other people. I guess the whole trouble must be that I don't look like them. They say it is a matter of race prejudice. But if it were prejudice a baby would have it, and you will never find it in a baby. It has to be inculcated on people. For one thing, I have noticed that this 'race prejudice' is not to be found in people who are sure enough of their position to be able to defy it. For example, the kindest, most courteous, most democratic man I ever met was the King of England, the late King Edward VII."

RED CROSS PROCLAMATION BY GOVERNOR WITHYCOMBE

Governor Withycombe of Oregon is the first governor in the United States to issue a Red Cross proclamation. Following is the proclamation issued on Saturday.

"At this holiday season of the year when, following time-honored custom, the spirit of giving prevails in every home of the land, it is entirely fitting and proper that each true American should feel disposed to give such support as he can afford to that great humanitarian arm of the federal government known as the American Red Cross.

"This is our first Christmas in the world war. It is our first opportunity to mingle with the usual holiday atmosphere a responsiveness to the most merciful and eloquent appeal for definite service that has ever been made to humane hearts. The larger part of the so-called civilized world is in distress. There are painful wounds to heal, torn bodies and souls that need ministry. There is no better, surer, quicker avenue of relief than through the undenominational agency of the American Red Cross whose noble officers have undertaken to mobilize the heart and soul and wealth of America 'toward binding up the wounds of a bleeding world.'"

"No matter how much we may give for the tender care of our soldiers and sailors who are obliged to play our parts at home must feel that any hardships and sacrifices endured by us are negligible in the light of the supreme labors performed by the stalwart sons of the land. The more we give the sooner this terrible war will end and the sooner an enduring peace will blot out its course across the now dull horizon.

"Now, therefore, I, James Withycombe, governor of the state of Oregon, by virtue of the authority in me vested, do most earnestly commend the Christmas membership drive of the Red Cross to the cheerful support of the people of Oregon and urge upon each Oregon household the imperative necessity of making this truly a Red Cross Christmas by giving a Christmas present to humanity. Let every Oregon home be represented in the great union of the Red Cross.

"In testimony whereof, I have hereunto set my hand and caused the great seal of the state of Oregon to be affixed this 14th day of December, 1917."

(Signed) JAMES WITHYCOMBE, Governor.

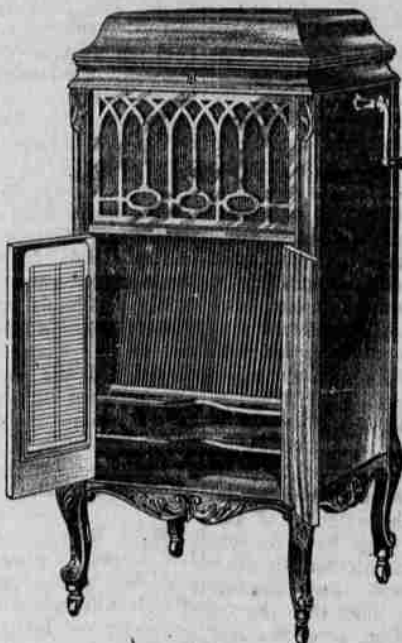
THE GAY PRINTER

Lo, the poor printer! He starts life as a "devil"—it is an infallible rule—and he finishes it—well, goodness only knows where! The printer's heritage is toil, his reward is a plain fir slab in a far, dark corner of the potter's field.

Ah, how few of us there are here tonight who understand the printer,

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SUES SCHOOL BOARD

Claims \$200 Fee for Aid in Bond Issue Floatation

A claim for a \$200 fee, with interest at 6 per cent from March 17, 1917, was filed against the board of directors of school district No. 108, Estacada, on Saturday by Keller Bros., an Arizona bond selling organization. According to the complaint, the school district contracted with Keller Bros. for the handling of an issue of \$25,000 in bonds to cover the cost of new building and in return were to give the agents \$200 for their work.

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